

Thunderbird used about 53 MB of RAM when we tested it.

IncrediMail Xe 5.7.0

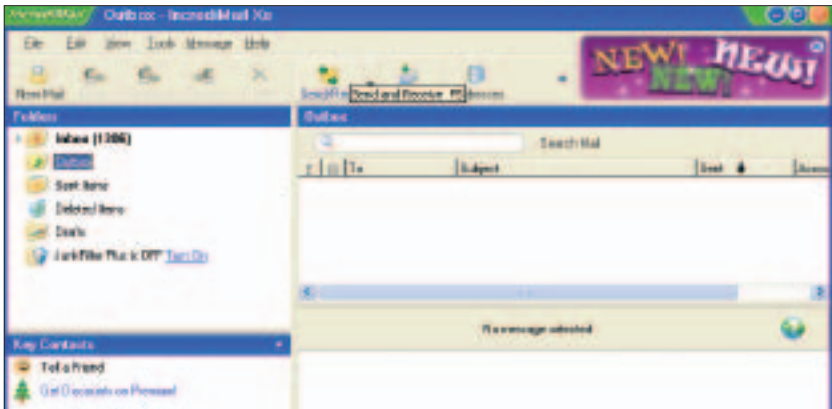
Warning: IncrediMail Xe is not particularly suited for business oriented work.

This is a very fun and friendly email client meant to put a smile on your face. This is a total step off the normal look that mail clients have. It gives users a totally fun-filled experience with a lot of colours and animations.

Setting up your email account is quite easy where the software itself auto detects the settings for different services like Gmail, Hotmail and Yahoo mail; once you enter your email address. Multiple accounts can be created in IncrediMail. IncrediMail has the feature to set rules for certain functions. e.g. you can create a folder in which the mail from your second account will be redirected into it. There was a problem we faced while setting up a hotmail account with IncrediMail. Even though the server URL was correct, we were unable to access hotmail through IncrediMail.

Separate user groups can be created to manage your contacts more efficiently. Emails can be dragged and dropped to categorise them. You can also block emails from particular users if needed.

IncrediMail gives you a complete visual treat. When you receive an email, an animated character pops up onto your



IncrediMail Xe – A very colourful experience

How We Tested

We looked, read and tested long and hard to bring you this list. We based our conclusions on performance, features and usability.

PC used for testing:

- Intel P4 @ 3.40GHz
- 768MB RAM
- Windows XP SP2

These are the features we looked for:

Multiple Accounts: Setting up and managing multiple accounts is the key feature for an email client to have.

Notifications: An email client needs to have a way of notifying the user on receiving a new email.

Rules and Filters: Rules and Filters are needed to help manage your emails in a better manner. Mails can be sorted out and automatically put into their respective folders.

Spam filtering: This is a must have for all email clients. Spam is everywhere and we need ways to stop the spam from taking. We looked for features where spam was automatically filtered out. We also checked to see if there was provision for the spam database to be updated.

Formatting: Formatting tools, themes and

screen which can actually be dragged around the screen. This is known as your Notifier. You can personalise your mail client by selecting a notifier you wish to use. Choices range from emoticons, animals to a butler bringing your mail on a plate. IncrediMail also allows you to download more notifiers from their Web site.

When sending an email you can select a background image for your email. Again there are

style-sets for emails were looked for. The last thing you want is a mail client that only writes in plain text.

Importing/Exporting: Importing and Exporting of Contacts, mails and account settings, while switching emails clients is definitely needed. It makes moving to a new client much simpler. It would be such a pain to sit and recreate an entire contact list if an email client did not support this feature.

Auto-reply: A nifty feature that will help users inform others that they are out of town or on vacation via an auto-reply. This is helpful when you know you are not going to check a particular email account when away.

Additional Features: There are many additional features that we looked for including Calendar, Advanced Contact Management and even RSS feed.

GUI: The Interface of an email client is very important. The simpler the interface, the easier it is for a user to use that particular email client.

Memory consumption: As mails and news items collect in a mail client, the software can get slow. This is the reason why memory consumption is one of the important factors to consider.

various categories to choose from along with the option to let you download more. This feature looks good but has its drawback. The person you are sending to might not be able to see the background (as in the case of Gmail) or the background maybe attached as an image (as in the case of hotmail). MS Outlook and eM Client can open the email with the background displayed though.

Going along with the fun theme for an email client, IncrediMail uses Comic Sans as the default font when creating an email.

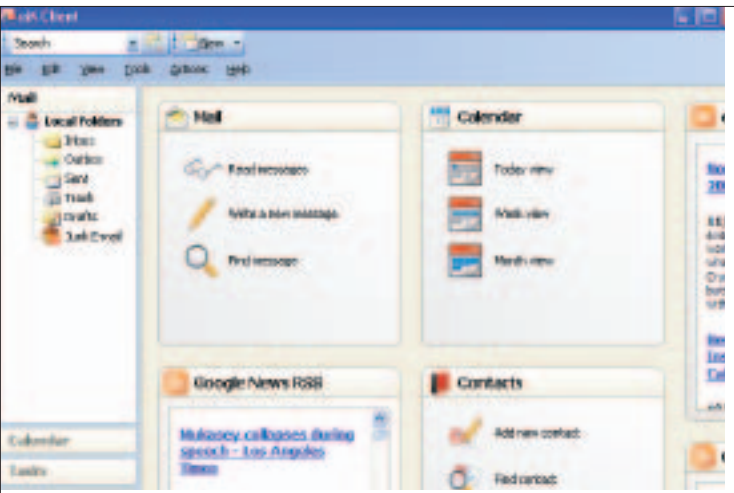
If you have multiple accounts set on IncrediMail you can easily select which account you want to use to send the email out. There is a button on the tool bar that allows you to attach a voice clip to your email. A grid is provided where you can use your mouse to create your signature. You can type out a signature with coloured fonts and use emoti-

cons provided as well. Images can be inserted into the signature as well. There is also a very nifty animation of your mail being sent. Even though you customise a signature, when an email is sent from IncrediMail, an ad, below your signature, linking to their Web site is always attached with your email.

A very interesting feature we found with this email client, was that of a Babylon translator for IncrediMail. If you receive an email in a language other than English, from a sender you know, you can translate it straight away. Even single words can be translated using this. There is a button shaped as a globe that on clicking will provide you with translating options.

There are a few features like JunkFilter Plus, Changeable Skins, Advanced Account Access, Letter Creator that need to be purchased if you want to use them, or are available only through the premium version of IncrediMail. But, we have to say this is a really good alternative for an email client.

IncrediMail may not have all the new features like RSS feeds but is definitely the most colourful email client and uses about 18 MB of RAM.



eM Client – Contains RSS feed, Tasks and Calendar

eM Client 1.1.3 BETA

eM client is a more up-to-date email client with additional features like Widgets, IM, RSS feed and others which are not present in IncrediMail. It is not as colourful and animated as IncrediMail though, but is good in its own simplistic way.

eM Client gives you a very Web browser type of look with widgets being the first thing you see after you setup your account. Separate widgets for Mail, Calendar, Tasks, Contacts and RSS feed widgets for eM Client News and Google News can be seen. You can change or add widgets according to your likes in settings when needed.

Gmail settings are automatically used when setting up a Gmail account. This is a plus point. The bad thing about this email client is that only email titles are downloaded, which means each email will be downloaded separately on opening, which is a big drawback to working offline.

	Thunderbird	IncrediMail	eM Client	Eudora	Pegasus
	2.0.0.18	Xe 5.7.0	1.1.3 BETA	7.1	Mail v4.41
Memory usage	53 MB	18 MB	75 MB	30 MB	13.5 MB
Multiple Accounts	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Notifications	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Importing/Exporting	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Rules and Filters	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Auto-reply	X	✓	X	X	X
Calendar	X	X	✓	X	✓
RSS feed support	✓	X	✓	X	X

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